

Aquifer Open Study Notes (Profiles)

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This resource has been adapted into multiple languages, including English, Tok Pisin, Arabic (عربي), French (Français), Hindi (हिंदी), Indonesian (Bahasa Indonesia), Portuguese (Português), Russian (Русский), Spanish (Español), Swahili (Kiswahili), and Simplified Chinese (简体中文).

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Women Named Mary

The Gospels mention four other Marys besides the mother of Jesus:

1. Mary Magdalene, likely from Magdala in Galilee, was freed from demon possession by Jesus (Mark 16:9). She became a loyal follower and supported Jesus and his disciples financially (Luke 8:1-3; see also Matthew 27:55-56; Mark 15:40-41). She witnessed Jesus die on the cross and his burial (Matthew 27:55-61; Mark 15:40-47; John 19:25; compare Luke 23:49, 55-56). She went to the tomb early on Sunday morning with burial spices. She was among the first to hear that Jesus had risen from the dead (Matthew 28:1-8; Mark 16:1-8; Luke 24:1-11, 22-24). She was also the first to see the risen Jesus (Matthew 28:9-10; Mark 16:9-11; John 20:1-2, 11-18).
2. Mary, the mother of James the younger (not the apostle) and Joseph, was among the women present when Jesus died on the cross and at his burial (Matthew 27:55-61; Mark 15:40-47; see also Luke 23:49, 55). Like Mary Magdalene, she was among the first to hear that Jesus had risen from the dead (Matthew 28:1-8; Mark 16:1-8; Luke 24:1-11). She was also one of the first to see the risen Jesus (Matthew 28:9-10).
3. Mary of Bethany was Martha and Lazarus's sister. Jesus loved their family very much (John 11:5). Jesus praised Mary for wanting to learn from him (Luke 10:38-42). Soon after Jesus raised her brother from the dead (John 11:32-45), Mary anointed the feet of Jesus with very expensive perfume. Jesus defended her when others said it was wasteful (John 12:1-11; compare Matthew 26:6-13; Mark 14:3-9).
4. Mary, the wife of Clopas, was among the women watching when Jesus died on the cross (John 19:25). The New Testament does not mention her husband, Clopas, elsewhere.

Passages for Further Study

Matthew 27:55-61; 28:1; Mark 15:40-47; 16:1-11; Luke 8:2-3; 10:38-42; 24:1-10; John 11:1-6, 17-24; 12:3-8; 19:25; 20:1-2, 11-18; Acts 12:12